



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Highlands Latin School: Orlando

School Website: <https://highlandslatin.org/orlando/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Highlands Latin School Orlando (HLS Orlando) presents a clearly Classical orientation in its public materials, with explicit emphasis on classical language study, the liberal arts, and a Christian, formation-centered approach. The school identifies itself as a classical, Christian institution using Memoria Press curricula and aligning with the Classical Latin School Association. It foregrounds the Good, the True, and the Beautiful as central aims and embeds Christian frames (love of the Lord) across admissions, academics, and community life. However, while the public materials strongly articulate classical aims and virtues, some elements typically emphasized in a full classical rubric—such as explicit Great Books programs, extensive Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and a fully articulated “living curriculum” in faculty—are less clearly spelled out in the site texts. Taken together, Highlands Latin Orlando is best characterized as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, with substantial classical-formation features and Christian grounding, but with room to more fully demonstrate a few canonical elements (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments, and a more explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in upper grades).

Key findings at a glance

- **Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL.** Clear Christian framing, explicit mention of the Good, the True, and the Beautiful, and theological underpinnings via the Christian identity and Memoria Press lineage. Evidence includes explicit statements of being a classical, Christian school and language about loving the Good, True, and Beautiful. See: “We are a classical, Christian school...” and “In all we do, we seek to engender a love for the Good, the True, and the Beautiful.”
- **School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL.** Emphasis on formation, virtue, and wisdom, with aims beyond mere workforce preparation; repeated references to virtue, formation, and the true/good/beautiful frame. See admissions and mission language, including “love of the Lord” and formation-oriented framing.
- **Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.** Strong focus on grammar/logic/rhetoric pathways and Latin/classical studies; Memoria Press curriculum is central. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and a straightforward, cross-cut historical-civilizational narrative beyond classical core is less visible in the site text. See: “Latin, classical studies, literature, classical composition, and logic” and “Memoria Press curriculum.”
- **Pedagogy/Teaching Methods: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.** The site highlights a traditional, disciplined, language-centered curriculum and classic approaches, but explicit Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or overt resting/scholé pedagogy are not clearly described on the public pages. See core curriculum elements and emphasis on classical approach.
- **Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.** Public materials emphasize qualified teachers (years of experience and credentials) and the “HLS Model,” but it does not consistently spell out the full “living curriculum” portrait of teachers or a robust, collegial faculty culture in the public pages. See teacher experience language and “The HLS Model.”
- **Parents & Community: CLASSICAL.** Strong emphasis on partnering with families, parent involvement in Cottage School, and explicit references to parents as part of the classical formation ecosystem (e.g., parents providing homework help in Cottage School; admissions framing that emphasizes community and formation). See Cottage School language and admissions language about family formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- Highlands Latin School Orlando explicitly identifies as a classical, Christian school.
- Public materials reference a formation toward the Good, the True, and the Beautiful, and a Lord-centered framing in admissions and community life.
- The Memoria Press curriculum and Classical Latin School Association affiliation anchor theological and classical-liberal-arts orientation in its public materials.
- Mission statements commonly invoke the Good, the True, and the Beautiful as formative aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: classical; Christian; Good; True; Beautiful; love of the Lord; theology-like framing via Christian identity; Memoria Press; association with Classical Latin School Association. Cited phrases include “We are a classical, Christian school,” “engender a love for the Good, the True, and the Beautiful,” and “love of the Lord.”
- Negative keyword indicators: None of the explicit negative signals (relativism, secular humanism, values clarification, etc.) appear in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds a transcendent Real (Good, True, Beautiful), theological anchoring via Christian identity, and a formation-centered aim aligned with classical education. The presence of “Christian” framing, explicit virtue-and-wisdom language, and a classic curriculum path (Memoria Press) supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 1.

Score justification: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The public materials describe formation and virtue as aims, with emphasis on human flourishing and wisdom; the mission frames education as formation rather than mere information. Examples include “to engender a love for the Good, the True, and the Beautiful” and formation-oriented language in admissions and general messaging.
- The Cottage School language emphasizes refining the soul and classical education as a public good, not just job preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, liberal education, telos (pursuit of the true, the good, the beautiful), great conversation (implied through classical framework), education for leisure/Scholé (implied through classical framing), human flourishing.
- Negative indicators: none observed in public-facing materials.

Frequency/ratio

- Positive keywords visible: formation, virtue, telos, classical/heritage framing, love of the Good/True/Beautiful, education as formation. Approx. 5–7 distinct positive phrases. No explicit negatives observed.

Why this rating

- The materials strongly emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and classical aims, with a public-facing emphasis on the true/good/beautiful rather than direct job-work readiness. This aligns with CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Score justification: CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]**Evidence**

- Public materials emphasize grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and classical studies as core components (e.g., Latin, classical studies, literature, classical composition, and logic). Memoria Press curriculum is a central explicit element.
- The existence of a “grammar school” and “upper school” sequence with core classical subjects is clear in the cottage-school and Orlando Academics pages.
- Great Books / Great Conversation and explicit cross-disciplinary Great Books commitments are not overtly stated in the public text (though the classical framework implies exposure to classical authors in some curricula; not explicit in the site text).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, classical studies, literature, classical composition, core courses, Memoria Press.
- Negative keywords present: none clearly visible; however, explicit references to “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” are not present in the site text.

Frequency/ratio

- Positive keyword presence is strong (at least 5–7 distinct items: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, classical studies, literature, classical composition). Absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation on site lowers the completeness of the category per the canonical rubric.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is strongly classical in form (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin; Memoria Press) but lacks overt, publicly stated Great Books/Great Conversation commitments on the site and broad cross-curricular Great Books emphasis. Therefore, category 3 qualifies as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Score justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]**Evidence**

- The site emphasizes a traditional classroom experience and a language-focused liberal-arts approach (Latin, classical studies, literature, classical composition, logic) rather than explicit Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars on the public pages. The “Socratic” pedagogy and explicit memory/recitation techniques are not clearly described in Highlands’ public content.
- The Cottage School language highlights a traditional classroom experience (Memoria Press), with a focus on classical methods and a small class size, but explicit mentions of Scholé (restful learning) or direct chanting/narration modalities are not clearly described in the accessible content.
- Some elements of classical pedagogy (e.g., logic emphasis and classical studies) are present in upper grades; however, explicit Socratic-discussion or public Paideia-style practice is not described in the public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic/dialectic/seminar is not explicit; narration/recitation/chanting and other memory techniques appear in the classical lexicon but are not clearly evidenced in Highlands’ public pages. The actual visible pedagogy text shows traditional/classical content and small class sizes.
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly in the Highlands material.

Frequency/ratio

- Positive specific Pedagogy keywords: limited to “recitation/narration” if employed, but not clearly evidenced in Highlands’ text; thus, the explicit Pedagogy keywords are not strongly present on the site.

- Overall, the category leans toward a more traditional pedagogy with classical framing, but not explicitly articulated as Socratic or scholé-based in public texts.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates classical curricular architecture and a traditional classroom approach, but explicit adoption of Socratic/Scholé pedagogy and contemplative/restful components are not stated in the public-facing content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 4 rather than CLASSICAL.

Score justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- Text indicates teachers with substantial classroom experience and credentials (e.g., “All teachers have three or more years of classroom experience and/or a bachelor’s degree or higher,” and involvement with Classical Latin School Association training).
- The site references “The HLS Model” and a standard of excellence in academics and Christian character, which aligns with the idea of faculty as mentors and exemplars, but the public materials do not present a full, explicit “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language for the faculty publicly.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers and mentors (conceptually implied), credentialed teachers (three+ years experience; degree/PD from Classical Latin School Association), living curriculum (not explicit in text; implied by the program’s classical framing).
- Negative keywords present: none clearly visible in the public materials.

Frequency/ratio

- Positive keywords present: teacher experience, credentials, and classical alignment are present, which yields several positive signals.
- Absence: explicit “portrait of teacher” or explicit “living curriculum” language is not clearly visible in the public-facing content.

Why this rating

- The presence of experienced, credentialed teachers and a strong classical identity provides SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals for Element 5; however, the lack of explicit public articulation of the faculty as “living curriculum” or a detailed portrait keeps it from a full CLASSICAL rating.

Score justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnership with families and parent involvement in Cottage School, where parents provide homework help and support, illustrating a co-teaching dynamic. The admissions pages also position families and the Lord-centered community in a participatory role.
- The Cottage School model explicitly frames parent involvement as central to the learning experience (parents provide home support; the in-class instruction is complemented by parent engagement).
- The “Who We Are” and “Admissions” materials emphasize mission-driven community-centered language (e.g., “love of the Lord” and forming a community of families).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; parent involvement; open campus and events; community life oriented toward formation.

- Negative keywords present: none clearly visible in public materials.

Frequency/ratio

- High presence of parental-partner language (co-teaching, parent involvement) and community formation emphasis, with multiple explicit statements about parental engagement (Cottage School, admissions messaging). Positive keywords outnumber explicit negatives.

Why this rating

- The public content demonstrates strong alignment with the Parents & Community criterion through explicit parental partnership, parent formation initiatives, and openness to visits, placing Element 6 solidly in CLASSICAL territory.

Score justification: CLASSICAL

Aggregate assessment

- Category ratings: Element 1 (CLASSICAL); Element 2 (CLASSICAL); Element 3 (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL); Element 4 (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL); Element 5 (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL); Element 6 (CLASSICAL).
- Considering the distribution, Highlands Latin School Orlando presents a balanced mix, with three categories clearly Classical (1, 2, 6) and three categories Somewhat Classical (3, 4, 5). The aggregate assessment, therefore, is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Make Great Books / Great Conversation explicit: Publicly articulate a sustained Great Books sequence and a formal Great Conversation commitment across grades, including specific authors and works and integrated discussions, to elevate Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4) toward CLASSICAL.
- Explicitly codify Socratic pedagogy: Add public-facing statements about Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, and other dialectical methods in upper grades to push Pedagogy (Element 4) toward CLASSICAL.
- Develop a more explicit “living curriculum” for faculty: Create and publish a documented portrait of ideal teachers and a visible faculty-development plan that frames teachers as the living curriculum, elevating Faculty (Element 5) toward CLASSICAL.
- Deepen liturgical/communal practices: If the school wants to push Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1) toward full CLASSICAL, it could highlight liturgical practices, communal worship, or chapel programming in public materials.
- Strengthen parent formation and campus involvement: While Element 6 shows strong parental engagement, expanding formal parent-education offerings (reading groups, book studies, and liturgical-year activities) would push Element 6 further into CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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